Horticulture 1 · Unit 8 · Level 2

Poinsettia Care & Pinching



TODAY'S PLAN

- 👥 Jobs
- ⚠️ Safety
- 🌺 Steps
- ✅ Check
- 📝 Reflect

Get ready

Jobs



Grower

Does the main plant job with the tools



Supply helper

Gets and returns supplies and tools to staff



Recorder

Takes photos and fills in the chart



Clean-up captain

Sweeps, wipes tables, checks hands are washed

Safety

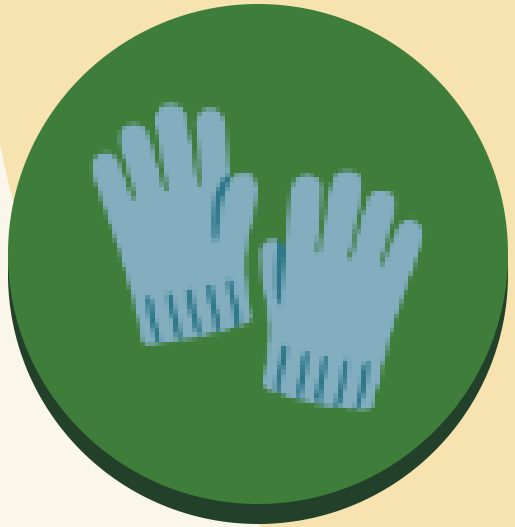
Be Safe



- 🧤 Wear **gloves** for soil, sap, fertilizer and rooting hormone.
- 👄 **Nothing in your mouth**: no plants, soil, seeds or berries.
- ✂️ Sharp tools only with an **adult at the station**. Cut away from your body.
- 🥛 Milky **sap** stings eyes and skin; latex allergy = nitrile gloves or skip.
- 🧪 **Staff only** spray pests. Students never touch sprays.
- 🧼 **Wash hands** when you finish.

Steps

Steps 1 of 2



1. 🧤 Nitrile gloves on (sap).
2. 👆 Check soil moisture with a finger.
3. 💧 If dry, water the soil until it drains; keep leaves dry.
4. 🔍 Inspect leaf undersides for whiteflies, mealybugs, mites.

Steps

Steps 2 of 2



1. ✌️ Pinching week: pinch the top inch above a leaf to make it bushy.
2. 📏 Measure height; count bracts coloring.
3. 📋 Log date, action and observation on the care chart.
4. 🧼 Wash hands; tell staff about any pests.

🃏 Check 1 of 3



When do you water a poinsettia?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ When the soil surface feels dry

2️⃣ Every hour

3️⃣ Never



When the soil surface feels dry

Check first.

🃏 Check 2 of 3



Pinching makes the plant…

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Taller and thinner

2️⃣ Die

3️⃣ Bushier with more bracts

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 3



Bushier with more bracts

Branching.

🃏 Check 3 of 3



Fine webbing under leaves suggests…

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Botrytis

2️⃣ Mites

3️⃣ Root rot

✅ Answer · Card 3 of 3



Mites

Mites.

Wrap-Up

Clean Up + Reflect



Return and count tools.

Sweep and wipe your area.

Wash hands, then do the reflection.